MONTHLY UPDATE

Ghana: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA

Summary of the month

The month closed on the ministry's own account of itself, and the honest half of it is the arithmetic: the coders programme holds 141,954 registrations against 5,812 completions, the rural telephony project 1,400 live sites of 2,016, and the network 8,578 fibre cuts projected for 2026 against a dig-once policy still awaiting Cabinet. Parliament passed the instrument for biometric SIM registration, which has not begun.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The communications minister told a UNESCO ministerial forum that government has begun implementing measures against the gaps a UNESCO readiness assessment found in digital infrastructure, AI capacity and cybersecurity resilience, reported on 15 September. No procurement, site or completion date is published for the investment figures attached to the plan. The communications minister announced a centralised technical review of every AI system bought by a public institution, scoped by the national information technology agency against interoperability, data-protection, cybersecurity and skills-transfer requirements; no directive or start date is published.

Legislation and regulation

The legislative programme itself got a ministerial account on 7 September: under a World Bank-backed acceleration project, a review of fifteen pieces of ICT legislation is about half complete, with stakeholder consultation already finished on part of it. An IMF technical assistance report finds the two regulators' crypto guidelines short of comprehensive oversight, with the regime under the Virtual Asset Service Providers Act set to go live in December 2026, and urges activity-based guidelines, finalised stablecoin rules and a transitional licensing regime; it puts annual crypto transactions at around US$21bn.

Data protection

The regulator's own first-half numbers reached the repository on 7 September, and they measure activity rather than enforcement: a 51.5% rise in regulatory activity and a 98.4% rise in newly registered data controllers over the first half of 2026, with a public campaign put at an estimated 25 million people reached. The controller figure is a growth rate published without the repository it grew from, and no fine or prosecution has yet been published. The President confirmed publicly in New York that Cabinet rejected the United States health agreement over demands for pathogen samples, medical records and exemption from the food and drugs regulator; the United States chargé d'affaires said on 29 September it was meant to taper assistance toward country ownership.

The refused health agreement is back on the table: the President said the United States had asked to reopen the compact, to amend or remove the clauses Ghana objected to on pathogen profiles and medical records.

Regional collaboration

Ghana's regional position moved on three fronts, none of them with a text attached. The communications minister was unanimously confirmed as the next chair of the African Union's Specialised Technical Committee on Communication and ICT, for two years from October 2026, the same statement naming participation in the Africa Network of Cybersecurity Authorities, an Arab Region roundtable and work with the Council of Europe's Cybercrime Convention Committee.

Standards

The central bank directed banks to give their fraud functions direct access to the chief executive, alongside work on implementing the directive.

On 8 October the central bank announced thematic reviews of how banks have implemented the revised cyber and information security directive.

The health service, with WHO support, convened a national workshop to review the Medical Records Strategy and Operational Guidelines, written nearly a decade ago, so that they cover electronic medical records, data governance, interoperability, cybersecurity and artificial intelligence. No revised text or adoption date is published.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

On 13 September a senior nursing officer was arrested and then charged with abetting the publication of false news under section 208 of the Criminal Offences Act and remanded without bail, over videos from a UK-based TikTok account; rights lawyers have put the detention and the evidence-gathering as constitutional questions, and the case returns to court on 30 September.

On 22 September the Secretary to the President asked the Media Foundation for West Africa and the Ghana Journalists Association to convene a national stakeholder engagement and draft a roadmap on hate speech and harmful online content, including guidance for law enforcement and alternatives to arrest and prosecution for speech that is not criminal. The letter cautions that arrests over criticism out of proportion to the conduct may be counterproductive, and sets no deadline.

Finance

New investments

The UN capital development fund began a second phase with a Ghanaian microcredit company on a US$200,000 grant it expects to catalyse US$1 million in loans and savings, after a first phase on US$30,000 that reached 470 enterprises across three regions and recorded 1,988 youth loans totalling GHS494,760.

A third, much smaller commitment closed the month: a Ghanaian remittance startup moving money from the United States to Ghana raised US$333,000 from a blockchain foundation's community fund, to launch an international payment card usable online and in stores. The commitment date is not stated in the source and no valuation, corridor volume or user count is published.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Spectrum assignment got a date on 7 September: the minister said that spectrum assignment would be completed and 5G deployment begin by December 2026, alongside a road-excavation coordination framework, an Emergency Telecommunications Framework and upgraded network-quality standards operators would be required to meet. It is a ministerial statement, not a published award timetable.

The build was then put in proportion. On 6 September the minister put the national requirement at about 6,000 additional cell sites against roughly 1,100 in the current round, which is to complete in 2027 — stated without the coverage or quality standard it is measured against. What is actually being built is 800 sites committed by the dominant operator with 180 already active and carrying traffic, and a 2026 plan of 2,698 sites at the second operator of which 1,890 are live within a network of roughly 9,000, and the regulator spent the week taking radio-frequency exposure messaging to market traders and transport operators in Koforidua after opposition to a mast at a lorry station — the cost of the build showing up as consent rather than capital.

The backbone under it is losing ground faster than the record showed. Industry now projects 8,578 fibre cuts nationwide in 2026, 4,289 of them already in the first half, at roughly US$2,045 a repair against more than US$20m spent on repairs in 2025, with major corridors averaging 72 cuts a month and uncoordinated excavation under the government's own road programme accounting for about half of road-related cuts. The dig-once policy that answers it has slipped again: a joint Cabinet memorandum with the roads ministry now awaits Cabinet, its third-quarter 2026 implementation target passed with no instrument on record. Against that, voice over LTE has risen from about 7% of traffic to 22.43% on 8.4 million subscribers.

The state's own operator got its board back. On 3 September a seven-member board was sworn in for the company behind the AT Ghana brand, releasing policy directives that had gone unimplemented for almost two months for want of one: spectrum in three bands from the regulator, and core-network access from the universal-access fund, both held back pending audited accounts. Neither the bands nor the terms of the access are published.

The first 5G spectrum is assigned. The regulator awarded both 700 MHz lots on 11 September to the dominant operator, the sole qualified applicant, for US$100.9m, US$100,000 above the floor its 40% premium set; one press account prints US$109.9m, against the regulator's own release. At the 2.3 GHz stage the second operator took all three lots it applied for, of five on offer, with neither the assignment date nor the fee stated.

On 25 September in New York the President discussed with Amazon's chief global affairs officer using the company's low-orbit satellite network to connect underserved communities. No partnership, licence application or service date has been announced. The dominant operator announced on 2 October that the regulator had notified it of 15-year awards of two lots in the 700 MHz band for US$100.9m and all three lots in the 3 GHz band for US$101.1m, to be deployed for 5G once the licences issue. The second operator's parent group signed a three-year, US$200m network modernisation memorandum with its Chinese equipment supplier.

Data Storage

The storage estate gained a number rather than a building. The communications minister put an artificial-intelligence computing centre at US$250m, beside US$200m for digitalisation, as the government's answer to capacity gaps a UNESCO readiness assessment identified. Nothing is procured, sited or dated, and no capacity figure accompanies either sum. Visiting the atomic energy commission on 9 October 2026, the science minister said its proposed AI data centre must operate under human oversight to protect sensitive nuclear information, and asked for governance arrangements to be built into the plan.

Cybersecurity

The response team behind the licensing regime published a volume figure for the first time: it handled 3,363 incidents between January and June 2026 and ran vulnerability assessments across 25 critical information infrastructure institutions. There is no breakdown by type, sector or outcome, so it establishes how much came in and nothing about what happened to it.

On 24 September the Ghana Cybersecurity Industry Forum, the industry platform provided for under section 81 of the Cybersecurity Act, set out its mandate under an interim president, covering threat-intelligence sharing and incident-response coordination, and named a shortage of cybersecurity professionals as its main problem. No founding date or membership count is published. The central bank said on 1 October it is developing a fraud intelligence hub for financial institutions to share emerging fraud patterns; no launch date is stated. The cyber security authority put incidents recorded between January and July 2026 at 3,876, about 47% of them online fraud. The communications minister said 13 critical information infrastructure sectors are designated and about 200 institutions identified as owners, with compliance mandatory. The Cyber Security Authority said Ghana, not the United States Federal Bureau of Investigation, led the operation that arrested eight suspects and rescued 120 suspected trafficking victims at cybercrime centres in Greater Accra.

DPI

Data Exchange

Kenya's president announced Masterkey, a cross-border wallet for verifiable qualification and work records whose first phase targets 150,000 placements, with Ghana, Rwanda and Kenya as its first countries, at an Accra event on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly. No Ghanaian implementing agency, cost or launch date is stated. The central bank counted 25,921,066 credit-bureau enquiries in 2025, down 12.12 per cent, while enquiries on digital borrowers rose from 13.1 million to 19.9 million.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The photocopy ban has an enforcer: the identification authority's head said verification teams will begin visiting institutions on 2 November 2026 to enforce the law against photocopying or visual inspection of the card.

The central bank republished its standing directive on 2 September: under regulation 7 of the 2012 national identity register regulations, the card has been the only identification accepted for transactions at every institution the bank licenses and regulates since 1 July 2022. The repository had carried that requirement only from a January 2026 guidance note. Dated four years earlier, it makes the photocopy ban an enforcement step against a rule already long in force rather than a new obligation.

The SIM half of the identity regime moved for the first time in nine months. The minister said on 7 September that Parliament has passed the legislative instrument governing SIM registration and the biometric verification phase will be introduced before the end of 2026, the same account putting completion of the 2021-2023 exercise it replaces at 44.28% of subscribers. What has moved is the authority to act: no start date, enrolment route or subscriber deadline is published and the instrument itself is not held.

The identification authority's head said the Ghana Card will become an electronic wallet secured by biometrics and PIN, introduced in phases, linked to bank accounts and loadable through authorised vendors. No date or central-bank approval is stated.

The licensing authority put its DVLAverify biometric identity-verification app on Apple's App Store on 23 September and opened a web verification platform, so vehicle-registration applicants can verify their identity remotely from a computer with a webcam. No user count is published. The foreign ministry and the regional commission ran a public campaign for the regional biometric card's acceptance at every member state's borders by December 2026. The identification authority began school-based registration of children aged 6 to 14 in the North East and Upper East Regions. The identification authority's deputy executive secretary said, reported 9 October 2026, that registration of children aged 0 to 5 would begin the following week, alongside the continuing registration of those aged 6 to 14.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The virtual-asset regime acquired its coordinating machinery. A five-agency committee is constituted and chaired by the central bank governor, joining the securities regulator, the finance ministry, the cyber security authority and the financial intelligence centre, working towards having the Virtual Asset Service Providers Act fully in force by 2027, and on 4 September the securities regulator admitted a second sandbox cohort of ten participants, run with the central bank to test and refine the framework the Act introduced, one of them a stablecoin infrastructure provider testing stablecoin payment, fiat settlement and wallet infrastructure under supervision. The cohort list, the first cohort's outcomes and the sandbox's exit criteria are not published.

The central bank widened its enforcement. On 8 September it named a second list of 20 unlicensed digital loan apps, five weeks after the first, warning banks and payment providers not to process for them; the register of licensed providers it undertook to publish is still not out.

On 23 September a fintech began opening bank-backed virtual accounts for its Ghanaian customers through an API integration with Universal Merchant Bank, which the central bank and the securities regulator had approved to offer virtual accounts to eligible virtual-asset businesses. The approval date is not stated.

On 6 October the central bank named a further twenty unlicensed loan apps and told banks and payment providers not to process for them, the third such list since August. A new dedicated electronic money issuer began operations the next day, and the governor used the occasion to give the measure of the market: about 85.8 million registered mobile money accounts in August 2026, of which about 26.4 million had been used in the previous ninety days.

Registries

A third registry arrived as a private product reading public records. Marrify launched in Accra on 28 August, letting users search and verify registered marriage and divorce records drawn from the registrar-general's department, the courts, district assemblies and the Gazette, presented by the gender ministry as answering the need for reliable information before people marry. No data-sharing agreement, fee schedule, coverage figure or record count is published, so what is established is that the records are searchable, not that they are complete.

The household registry published its national total: 11.24 million people in 2,906,288 households across all 16 regions, 508,870 households classed extremely poor, the base for cash-grant targeting as that programme's ceiling rises to 450,000 households.

Sectoral management information systems

The health insurer described electronic claims, biometric member verification and one-time attendance codes as in operation, with active membership at 70% in August 2026 against an 80% year-end target, its own account with no claims or rejection figures.

The education ministry said more than 6,000 of 8,000 complaints against this year's computerised school placements had been resolved, with reopening left at 18 September.

The revenue authority said collection of the tax on cross-border digital services through its Sentinel system starts on 15 October 2026.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The paper record gained a contract. The ministry said on 7 September that a contract had been signed on 13 August to digitise 3.5 million public records held by the Public Records and Archives Administration Department, as part of moving public administration off paper. No contractor, value, timetable or completion date was stated.

The Rent Control Department's acting commissioner called for an investigation into a digitisation programme on which US$1.7m was reportedly spent, having found four computers at the facility. No audit finding is held.

The tourism authority's chief executive said on 18 September that a Ghana Tourism Information System will carry the sector's registration, licensing and renewal, levy filing and payment, establishment records and public verification. No launch date, cost or vendor is stated.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Local government has gone in one month from a reform strategy's integration target to a signed programme covering every assembly in the country. The Office of the Head of the Local Government Service signed a memorandum on 3 September with a Ghanaian networks company to turn all 261 metropolitan, municipal and district assemblies into what both parties call smart assemblies, spanning waste management, public safety, education, healthcare, environmental monitoring and citizen engagement. No contract value, financing structure or timeline is stated, which is the whole of what would make it testable. Separately a governance organisation launched a citizen-reporting platform in South Tongu District that routes service-delivery complaints to the assembly and keeps the reporting citizen informed until resolution - a civil-society instrument in one district, not an assembly system.

Assembly business is to be put on air: the local government ministry announced live nationwide broadcasts of assembly general meetings and town halls with the civic education commission and the state broadcaster, with no start date.

Technology

AI

Two applied systems launched outside government. The development bank's AI platform gives farmers agronomic guidance and loan officers portfolio intelligence on a messaging app, after a pilot of more than 8,500 queries in three months, and a non-profit with the dominant operator opened a toll-free voice line answering in six languages, an AI system included, for callers without data.

Two automated systems reported. The police set 1 October 2026 for full automated traffic enforcement, with camera-captured offences reviewed before notices go out by SMS and fines paid through Ghana.gov within 14 days, after a pilot that issued about 120,000 caution notices. The revenue authority put customs collections at up to US$450m a month against about US$350m before its AI valuation system, its own figure and higher than the finance ministry's monthly series.

Two disability systems came out of one university. Researchers at the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology presented SignTalk-Gh, a working model that translates Ghanaian Sign Language to text and audio and back for doctor-patient consultations, not yet deployed in any hospital, and its Responsible AI Lab now hosts a

continental Hub for AI and Disability Inclusion, launched with a network for finding disability datasets and a first-year inventory of them. A commentator's account puts the start of fining under the automated traffic system back a month, to 1 November, after complaints of poor sensitisation.

The central bank's governor said a directive on the use of artificial intelligence in the financial sector is in drafting; no draft or date is published.

Capacity

Literacy

The cyber security authority launched the 2026 National Cyber Security Awareness Month on 2 September, themed on securing the digital finance system, and an education charity launched a nine-month programme on 1 September to certify 60 community digital champions across 52 communities under a Mastercard Foundation fellowship. Neither reports a reach figure.

Training and skills

The ministry said on 7 September that it had signed memoranda with eleven universities to embed digital certifications into degree and diploma programmes, naming five of them and leaving six, the certifications, the start date and any student number unstated.

The coders programme published its funnel rather than a headline for the first time: 141,954 registered accounts, 27,782 admitted learners and 5,812 logged course completions as at 2 August 2026, cybersecurity the largest track at 8,570, with 30,444 admitted through one commercial platform, 10,143 through a second and 24,394 learners self-paced. Registration is not admission and admission is not completion, and it is the ratio between them rather than any one number that measures the programme against its target of a million.

The coders programme is to reach first-year degrees: the minister said 12 universities have signed memoranda to carry its courses in Level 100.

The TVET Service signed a memorandum with UNESCO, KPMG and Microsoft under the AI EmpowerED initiative to train at least 100,000 TVET facilitators in AI and digital skills, reported on 23 September. No cost or timeline is stated.

Two school-level commitments were announced without money. The education ministry said it would open dialogue on a policy to scale a community ICT laboratory model nationwide, and Ghana signed an agreement with Intel to bring AI education into K-12 classrooms in New York; neither states a cost, a timeline or a school count. The Korean ambassador said the Korean aid agency is launching a US$28m digital basic education programme for 2026 to 2032.

Research institutions

The month's research capacity news is a funding gap stated by the minister who has to close it. Education Minister Haruna Iddrisu said the US$30 million Chinese government grant for a University of Science and Technology at Damongo will not be enough to complete and equip it, putting the full cost at more than US$100 million; the university is intended as a centre for robotics, digital sciences and artificial intelligence in a region that currently has none. The grant itself was disclosed at a working visit by the incoming Chinese ambassador, and neither account dates it beyond the previous year.

Inclusion

Access to services

Fieldwork for a research network's first multi-country survey of how people experience digital identity and digital payment systems, to reach more than 5,000 households through to April, began in the week to 7 September. It asks whether the systems leave people feeling more included.

Digital divides

The rural project's own numbers reached the repository on 5 September. 1,400 of 2,016 rural telephony sites are live and the universal-access fund carries a GHS 30m allocation for the project in 2026, with the minister directing that every site be upgraded to at least 4G on the ground that 2G and 3G no longer carry the services the sites exist to deliver, a directive repeated on an Eastern Region site inspection the next day. It carries no timetable, cost or contracting route, and 616 sites are not yet live. Above it, smartphone penetration is put at 71.8% in June 2026 against 27.5% a decade earlier — the minister's figure, on a different base from the household survey the record already holds.

Data

National statistics

The statistical service and Statistics Denmark agreed the design of a third three-year phase of their cooperation, centred on integrating administrative data held by ministries and agencies; no start date or funding figure is stated.

Open data

An air-quality system reached testing: a national air quality data hub built at a university laboratory went through utility testing with the environmental agency, which is to own it once a sustainability plan is agreed.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-12**
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/GHA/GHA-monthly-2026-10-12.pdf
FEEDBACK	info@data-landscapers.io
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0